

Masahiro Suzuki

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Postdoctoral Researcher, Chalmers University of Technology

Research member, [ENTAP](#)

Profile

I am a postdoctoral researcher at Chalmers University of Technology, examining the empirical co-evolution of climate policies and energy transitions against the pace required for climate-change mitigation. I defended my PhD in May 2024 on political acceleration in energy transitions and received multiple academic awards, including the Best Dissertation Award and the Early Career Scientist Award. Prior to my PhD, I worked on Japanese climate policy and attended UNFCCC COPs as a national delegate, collaborating internationally on long-term transition strategies, targets, and policies.

Employment

- 2024–present **Postdoctoral Researcher**, Chalmers University of Technology, Gothenburg
Analysing the co-evolution of climate policies and energy transitions.
- 2019–2024 **Visiting Researcher**, NewClimate Institute, Cologne
Assessed progress of climate mitigation efforts in major economies ([Climate Action Tracker](#)).
- 2014–2017 **Policy Researcher**, Institute for Global Environmental Strategies, Hayama
Participated in international negotiations, including UNFCCC COPs, as a national delegate focusing on long-term strategy and the global stocktake.
- 2009–2012 **Marketing Sales Executive**, SAP Japan, Tokyo
Conducted market analysis and business development; appointed to lead a five-person team as the unit's youngest team leader. Independently proposed and led a company-wide sustainability initiative following the 2011 Great East Japan Earthquake.

Education

- 2017–2024 **PhD (Summa Cum Laude) in Environmental Sciences and Policy**, Central European University (CEU), Vienna

Dissertation: Political Acceleration in Energy Transitions: Historical Interventions and Their Outcomes in the G7 and the EU, compared to Net-Zero Targets ([Download](#)).
- 2012–2014 **MSc (Distinction) in Environmental Sciences, Policy and Management (MESPOM)**, Joint degree from CEU, University of Manchester, Lund University, University of the Aegean

Thesis: Adherence to the Past or Hope for the Future?: The Historical Development of Japan's Energy Politics and its Implications for Future Nuclear Policy. ([Download](#)).
- 2005–2009 **BA in International Liberal Arts Studies**, Waseda University, Japan
Supplemented by a one-year exchange programme at Kalamazoo College (USA).

Awards and Honours

- 2026 Best Paper Prize, Energy-PPG at ECPR General Conference
- 2024 Best Dissertation Award, CEU
- 2024 Early Career Scientist Award, *Energy Research & Social Science*
- 2023 Environmental Research Conference 2023 Most Highly Rated Poster Award
- 2022 CIVICA Research Conference Poster Award
- 2019 CEU Award for Advanced Doctoral Students
- 2017–2023 CEU Doctoral Scholarship and Supplementary Grants

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

- 2026 Jewell, J., Cherp, A., Geels, F. W., **Suzuki, M.**, Nacke, L., Tosun, J., Bhowmik, S., Kazlou, T., Jakhmola, A. and Vinichenko, V., Policy-driven growth of technologies to accelerate climate action. *Nature Reviews Earth & Environment*, 7, 235–252. doi:10.1038/s43017-026-00765-3
- 2023 **Suzuki, M.**, Jewell, J., Cherp, A., Have climate policies accelerated energy transitions? Historical evolution of electricity mix in the G7 and the EU compared to net-zero targets. *Energy Research & Social Science*, 106, 103281. doi:10.1016/j.erss.2023.103281
- 2017 Cherp, A., Vinichenko, V., Jewell, J., **Suzuki, M.**, Antal, M., Comparing electricity transitions: A historical analysis of nuclear, wind and solar power in Germany and Japan. *Energy Policy*, 101, 612–628. doi:10.1016/j.enpol.2016.10.044

Manuscripts in Preparation

Suzuki, M., Jakhmola, A. and Jewell, J., Renewable ambition outpaces delivery, especially after the Paris Agreement.

Jakhmola, A., **Suzuki, M.** and Jewell, J., Assessing the realism of wind and solar targets and scenarios against probabilistic projections and realized outcomes.

Research & Policy Outputs

- 2022 **Suzuki, M.**, Feasibility of Germany's newly proposed RES targets. [POLET Blog](#).
- 2021 Kuramochi, T., Weishaupt, M., Höhne, N., **Suzuki, M.**, et al., 1.5°C-consistent benchmarks for enhancing Japan's 2030 climate target. Climate Action Tracker, Berlin.
- 2019 Kuramochi, T., Nascimento, L., de Villafranca Casas, M.J., Fekete, H., de Vivero, G., Lui, S., Kurdziel, M., Moisio, M., Tanguy, P., Jeffery, L., Schiefer, T., **Suzuki, M.**, et al., Greenhouse gas mitigation scenarios for major emitting countries – Analysis of current climate policies and mitigation commitments: 2019 update. NewClimate Institute, Cologne.
- 2017 Hildebrand, J., Heib, S., Rau, I., Knemeyer, A.K., Wörten, C., Holzhausen, G., Tamura, K., **Suzuki, M.**, et al., Strategic framework and socio-cultural aspects of the Energy Transition. GJETC, Wuppertal/Tokyo.
- 2016 Tamura, K., **Suzuki, M.**, Yoshino, M., Empowering the ratchet-up mechanism under the Paris Agreement. IGES, Hayama.
- 2015 **Suzuki, M.**, Yoshino, M., Tamura, K., Kojima, S., Historical and recent trends of CO₂ emissions: current status and ways to close the gap towards the 2°C target. In *The Paris Climate Agreement and Beyond: Linking Short-term Climate Actions to Long-term Goals*, IGES, Hayama.

Conference Presentations

- 2026 Renewable ambition outpaces delivery, especially after the Paris Agreement, *ECPR General Conference*, Krakow (September 8–11)
- 2023 Have climate policies accelerated energy transitions?
Poster: *Environmental Research 2023* (online, November 22–23); oral presentation: *ECPR General Conference*, Prague (September 4–8); also presented at *STRN International Sustainability Conference*, Utrecht (August 30–September 1).

Are energy transitions under climate policies different?, *8th NEST Conference*, Dresden (June 29–July 2)
- 2022 Mitigating climate crisis: evolution of the electricity sector (1960–2020) and gap to achieve 1.5°C in G7 and EU, *CIVICA Research Conference (poster)*, Budapest (September 1–2)

Evolutions of electricity transitions (1960–2020): Gap for achieving net-zero in G7 by 2035, *Scenarios Forum 2022 (poster)*, Vienna (June 20–22)

- 2019 The role of the state in the decline of incumbent energy sectors, *STRN International Sustainability Conference*, Ottawa (June 26–29)

Invited Talks

- 2026 Renewable ambition outpaces delivery, especially after the Paris Agreement, *University of Tokyo*, Tokyo, Japan (forthcoming, October)
- Policy-driven growth of technologies to accelerate climate action, *University of Tokyo*, Tokyo, Japan (forthcoming, October)
- 2025 「気候変動緩和のためのエネルギー転換の加速：これまでの成果と今後の実現性および課題について」 [Accelerating Energy Transitions for Climate Change Mitigation: Progress to Date, Future Feasibility, and Challenges]., *National Institute for Environmental Studies (NIES)*, *Environmental Economics Collaboration Group Seminar*, Online (February 13)
Presented in Japanese.
- 2024–2025 PhD Student Mentoring Session, *Central European University*
Invited by CEU faculty in two consecutive years to share experiences and practical guidance on interdisciplinary research, developing research questions, thesis writing, publication, and navigating doctoral study.

Professional Engagement & Event Organisation

- 2017 Research Seminar Organiser, *Cooperation on Low-carbon Technology Transfer between Businesses and Cities*, Warsaw (February 11–16)
- 2016 National Delegate of Japan, *COP22 — 22nd Conference of the Parties (UNFCCC)*, Marrakesh (November 7–18)
- Research Workshop Organiser, *China-Japan Policy Research Workshop: Climate and Energy Policies after the Paris Agreement*, Beijing (June 23)
- Side Event Organiser, *UNFCCC Bonn Climate Change Conference — Asia's Ambition for Nationally Determined Contributions*, Bonn (May 24)
- IGES Delegate, *6th session of the IRENA General Assembly*, Abu Dhabi (January 16–17)
- Side Event Organiser, *UNFCCC Bonn Climate Change Conference — Asia's Ambition for Intended Nationally Determined Contributions*, Bonn (June 4)

Teaching & Supervision

Teaching — Chalmers University of Technology

- 2024–present [Energy Transitions \(SEE160\)](#)
Contributed to course design; delivered lectures; assessed student presentations and examinations.
- 2024 Air Negotiations Simulation Game (AirSim)
Facilitated a simulated international negotiation on transboundary air pollution and guided participating students.

Supervision — Chalmers University of Technology

- 2025 [Climate Change & Renewable Energy Targets](#)
Bachelor's thesis; five-student group project.

Japanese-Language Publications

Policy Reports

- 2021 Kuramochi, T., Weishaupt, M., Höhne, N., **Suzuki, M.**, et al., 「日本の 1.5°C ベンチマーク: 2030 年温暖化対策目標改定への示唆」 [1.5°C-consistent benchmarks for enhancing Japan's 2030 climate target]. Translated by Kuramochi, T. and **Suzuki, M.**. Climate Action Tracker, Berlin.
- 2016 **Suzuki, M.**, Tamura, K., 「脱炭素化を見据えた長期戦略: G7 の戦略策定状況と概要」 [Long-term decarbonisation strategies in the G7]. IGES, Hayama.
- Suzuki, M.**, 「パリ協定後の気候対策: 世界長期目標/各国長期戦略/国別目標の役割」 [Climate change policies after the Paris Agreement]. Climate Edge (25), IGES, Hayama.
- 2015 Tamura, K., Kojima, S., Kuramochi, T., **Suzuki, M.**, 「パリ合意とその先を目指して: 気候変動対策における短期行動と長期目標を結びつける」 [The Paris climate agreement and beyond]. IGES, Hayama.
- New Climate Economy, 「新しい気候経済統合報告書」 [Better Growth, Better Climate]. Translated by Goto, A. and **Suzuki, M.**. New Climate Economy, Washington, D.C.

Government-Commissioned Reports

Yoshino, M., **Suzuki, M.**, Wakiyama, T., Miyatsuka, A., Fujisaki, T., 「各国の気候変動政策の概要」 [Overview of climate mitigation policies]. MOEJ, Tokyo.

Languages & Skills

Languages Japanese (Native); English (Fluent); German (Intermediate); Swedish (Beginner)
Software Advanced: R, Overleaf, Inkscape, Notion, Microsoft Office; Intermediate: Adobe Illustrator

Academic References

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